Podocarpus lawrencei 'Blue Gem'

Blue Gem Podocarpus, Blue Mountain Plum-pine

Family: Podocarpaceae

Rockery: 8 **TOTAL 8**



HABIT

Not available

FALL

Not available

LEAF



EXTRA

QUICK FACTS

Plant type
Tree

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen. Short flat blue-green needles; new growth in spring pink, red, or creamy with purple tinge, maturing blue-green. Spreading, arching branches with nodding tips. Can be sheared for low hedge. No significant fall color change. [Oregon State University; Trees and Shrubs Online; Great Plant Picks]

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: Dwarf spreading or mounding evergreen conifer. Typically 2–4 ft tall and 3–10 ft wide in 10 years; some reports to 4 ft × 8–12 ft at maturity. Slow to moderate growth (~15 cm/year). Female clone. [Oregon State University Landscape Plants; RHS; American Conifer Society; Great Plant Picks]

Soil
Not stated

Sun

Water

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Selection of Podocarpus lawrencei (syn. P. alpina), native to southwest Australia and Tasmania (sub-alpine regions). Cultivar raised in Tasmania prior to 1983 or selected in UK/Australia trade. [Oregon State University; Trees and Shrubs Online; American Conifer Society]

Form
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Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Siting
Not stated

Soil prep
Not stated

Depth & spacing
Not stated

Best planting season
Not stated

Establishment
Plant in full sun to light shade in well-drained soil. Drought tolerant once established. Tolerates pruning and shearing well for low hedge or ground cover. Suitable for rock gardens, front of border, containers (with care). [Great Plant Picks; Ashwood Nurseries; RHS]

HEALTH

Problem	Symptoms
Health	Generally pest and disease free. Resistant to aphids, slugs, snails reported. No serious problems stated for this cultivar. [Great Plant Picks; Burncoose]